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Image 7 of The weekly Floridian (Tallahassee, Fla.), August 20, 1889

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RIVERS LOVE AGAIN.

The Bad Man from Tallahassee in More Dirty Work.

Last March Rivers Love, an escaped criminal from State prison, committed a burglary in this town, says the Monticello Constitution, and in less than twelve hours Sheriff Simkins had him bound in irons, but as he was an escaped convict serving a life sentence for setting fire to a building in Tallahassee, he could not be tried for the robbery he committed in this town. He was turned over to the authorities at the prison camps, and in less than two weeks he had made his escape again, and came directly back to this county, where he has several brothers living. Sheriff Simkins soon got on his trail, and kept up with his movements very well, but never had an opportunity of capturing him.

A few weeks after Love's escape from the penitentiary Mr. Braswell was murdered and robbed at his home in Madison county. The afternoon before he was murdered that night, Love was seen talking to Braswell, (a fact Sheriff Simkins has recently ascertained) so the Major, suspecting Love, deputized Mr. Charles W. Henry, and they together commenced some detective work and soon found out that Frank Brooks, one of the worst colored criminals in the county, was spending money very lavishly and had gotten a gentleman of this town to order him two fine pistols, of which the Major had secured the numbers before they had been

had secured the numbers before they had been in town two hours. Major Simkins and Mr. Henry having worked the case successfully thus far, they needed other assistance, so the Major sent to Atlanta for a colored detective and put him on Frank Brooks' trail. He dined, drank and slept with Brooks until he had gained his full confidence. He found out that Rivers Love was living with a negro woman near Brooks' house and that he was furnishing him with this money he had been spending so lavishly and purchasing arms for himself and Love to protect him, (Love) against arrest. They also had evidence that Arthur Nicholson was harboring Love from arrest. So on Saturday morning sheriff Simkins, Messrs. C. W. Henry and John Johnson started out to make the arrests. On their way they were informed that Brooks and Nicholson were in town. Mr. Johnson was therefore sent back to make the arrest and soon succeeded in capturing them both and placed them in jail. Sheriff Simkins and Mr. Henry went on hoping to capture Love. When they reached Lucy Thompson's house, the woman Love was living with, they went in, but Love was not to be found, but they succeeded in securing his pistol, which was under the pillow on his bed, a dark lantern, a coat and vest, rubber coat, pocket book, which contained some of his papers, a small leather satchel and several boxes of pistol and Winchester rifle cartridges. After securing these they went over to Brooks' house where they found a new repeating Winchester rifle with part of a ramrod, the other part being

in Love's satchel, and also a dark lantern.

After a thorough search for Love, the gentlemen gathered up the articles and brought Lucy Thompson to town, and that afternoon they were arraigned before Judge Puleston for a preliminary trial. The Judge placed Brooks' bond at \$1,000, and Nicholson's at \$600.

Monday morning Nicholson succeeded in giving bond, and was released, but Brooks bears such an unenviable reputation that he will have to remain in prison until his trial, the penalty for the crime of which he is charged being seven years in State prison.

Since Saturday Sheriff Simkins has learned that Love was in Lucy Thompson's house when they got in sight, and as soon as he spied the officers he made his escape, taking with him a new Winchester repeating rifle. The officers would have succeeded in capturing him but the house is so constructed that there is only one place of exit, and that on the back side, facing a dense swamp where a prisoner once gets into it is impossible to find him. Love must have been on the alert for the officers and spied them through a crack in the rear of the building as they made their approach.

Frank Brooks bears a bad reputation, and has been arrested nearly a dozen times in connection with other parties for crimes committed in his section, and has always been acquitted, and invariably the other parties interested were sent to the penitentiary.

Sheriff Simkins certainly deserves praise by every law-abiding citizen of Jefferson county for

working up the case as he has done, and no doubt before he gets through with it he will succeed in breaking up one of the worst gangs in the whole county.

In Memoriam.

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